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Original practice paper

JAMB UTME Use of English: Practice Paper 1

A short comprehension passage and sixteen lexis and structure questions, all original, with explanations.

Exam	Subject	Questions	Time
JAMB UTME	**Use of English**	**20**	**20 minutes**

Instructions

- Read the passage carefully before you answer questions 1 to 4.
- Choose the option that best completes or answers each question.
- Answers and explanations are on the last pages.

Read the passage below and answer questions 1 to 4.

Every evening, Bisi's grandmother sat on the veranda and told stories about the old market at the centre of their town. She described traders who arrived before dawn with baskets of yam and pepper, and the noise of bargaining that rose with the sun. Bisi had never seen that market; a modern shopping centre now stood in its place. Yet when she walked past its glass doors, she sometimes imagined the smell of roasted corn and the songs of the women who once sold it. Her grandmother's stories, she realised, had built a second market in her mind, one that no bulldozer could reach.

1. Where did Bisi's grandmother tell her stories?

A In the kitchen
B In the shopping centre
C On the veranda
D At the market

2. What now stands where the old market used to be?

A A school
B A new market
C A modern shopping centre
D A bus park

3. The phrase 'one that no bulldozer could reach' suggests that Bisi's memories

A are about building
B will soon fade
C cannot be destroyed
D are frightening

4. The writer's attitude to the old market is best described as

A critical
B angry
C nostalgic
D indifferent

Lexis and structure

5. Choose the option nearest in meaning to the word in capitals: The principal was ADAMANT about the new rules.

A firm
B angry
C careless
D unsure

6. Choose the option opposite in meaning to the word in capitals: Her account of the event was VAGUE.

A dull
B clear
C unclear
D long

7. Each of the students ___ a calculator.

A have
B has
C are having
D were having

8. Neither the coach nor the players ___ happy with the result.

A has been
B is
C were
D was

9. The news ___ shocking.

A was
B were
C have been
D are

10. She is very good ___ mathematics.

A in
B on
C with
D at

11. Choose the option nearest in meaning: The athlete gave a REMARKABLE performance.

A average
B outstanding
C poor
D ordinary

12. Choose the option opposite in meaning: The trader was GENEROUS to his customers.

A stingy
B kind
C polite
D wealthy

13. By the time we arrived, the film ___.

A starts
B has started
C had started
D was start

14. You are coming to the party, ___?

A isn't it
B aren't you
C are you
D don't you

15. To let the cat out of the bag means to

A free an animal
B cause trouble
C reveal a secret
D make a mistake

16. Choose the option nearest in meaning: The manager's reply was PROMPT.

A rude
B late
C careful
D quick

17. Choose the option opposite in meaning: The hall was CROWDED.

A large
B noisy
C empty
D full

18. Choose the correctly spelt word.

A acommodation
B accommodation
C accomodation
D accommodasion

19. The students, as well as their teacher, ___ present.

A has been
B were
C is
D was

20. If I ___ you, I would apologise.

A was
B am
C were
D will be

Answers and explanations

Mark your paper first, then read the explanation for every question you missed.

1. **C**	2. **C**	3. **C**	4. **C**	5. **A**
6. **B**	7. **B**	8. **C**	9. **A**	10. **D**
11. **B**	12. **A**	13. **C**	14. **B**	15. **C**
16. **D**	17. **C**	18. **B**	19. **B**	20. **C**

1. C. The first sentence says she sat on the veranda.

2. C. The passage says a modern shopping centre now stood in its place.

3. C. A bulldozer destroyed the real market, but it cannot touch what is in her mind.

4. C. The writer remembers the market fondly and with longing.

5. A. Adamant means refusing to change your mind.

6. B. Vague means unclear, so the opposite is clear.

7. B. Each is singular and takes a singular verb.

8. C. With neither…nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject, players.

9. A. News is uncountable and singular.

10. D. We say good at a subject or skill.

11. B. Remarkable means unusually good.

12. A. Generous means giving freely; the opposite is stingy.

13. C. An action finished before another past action takes the past perfect.

14. B. A positive statement with are takes the tag aren't you.

15. C. The idiom means telling something that was meant to be secret.

16. D. Prompt means done without delay.

17. C. Crowded means full of people; the opposite is empty.

18. B. Accommodation has double c and double m.

19. B. The verb agrees with the main subject, students, not with the phrase after as well as.

20. C. Imagined situations take were in formal English.